do more than this would indeed involve writing a book longer than that written by Zaehner himself.

To start, it may be worthwhile to recall a few common distortions of Indian philosophical and religious thought presented by foreign writers over the years. By now, I suppose, they are all well known. Almost all of them have propagated the idea that both Indian philosophies and religions are immanentist, absolutist, or mystic; that the Hindus have no theism, no personal God, no two-way traffic between man and God; that the Hindus are interested only in the internal state of peace of mind, a characterless existence, are life-negating and pessimistic in their outlook, recognize no final reality, significance of ethical values, or moral obligation, believe in no independent authority of reason either in their philosophies or their religions, and show lack of interest in the problem of evil, etc. These are but a few of the prevalent, incorrect characterizations of Indian thought. There are a host of others, because Indians are supposed to be dominated also by numerous positive dogmas such as the law of *karma,* reincarnation, the law of *dharma,* desirelessness and non-attachment, *mokṣa,* absolute non-injury to any life, etc. The purpose of this article is neither to make a comprehensive list of such distortions nor to dispute them. If Zaehner, or anyone else, had said that Indian philosophical and religious literature includes all this but also much more which is different from this and which is no less representative and typical than the former, we would have had no quarrel with him. By temperament, Indians are too prone to find everything everywhere and will rest the matter there. But when a Spalding Professor of Eastern Religions and Ethics attempts to perpetuate the most unimaginable absurdities about Eastern religions, he must be corrected, even though it may be difficult to argue with a person who is sure that God reveals truth only to His chosen people and withholds it from all others.

There is nothing wrong in misreading the history of any philosophical literature—Indian, Chinese, Japanese, or Western—and forming one's own comparisons and contrasts on the basis of such misunderstandings, because one still remains at the standpoint or on the level of philosophy and can there be challenged on his own ground. It is more serious when someone compares and condemns, say, the philosophy of the Western world from the standpoint of Christian theology or religion, or judges the empirical religions of the world, not from any well-established logical standpoint applicable to all the religions of the world, but only from the standpoint and standard of a particular exclusive revelation. It is still worse if